



English 4 | Week 1

Introduction to Academic Writing

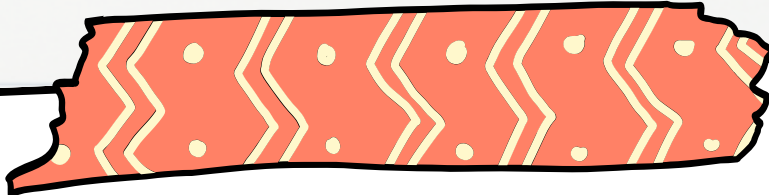


Learning objectives

At the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

- identify the reasons of writing;
- identify the methods of writing;
- identify the target audience/readers of writing and how to capture their attention
- write a paragraph by asking questions and taking notes.





What is Academic Writing?

- It is the art of communicating ideas, research findings, and arguments in a way that is clear, structured, and formal.
- In academic writing, students learn how to engage in intellectual discourse, contribute to the increasing body of knowledge, and demonstrate their understanding of different concepts of specialization. Academic writing forms the backbone of university studies, and its mastery is of utmost importance for success in the academe and eventually in the professional arena.



Three Essential Question in Writing

01



Why do you
write?

02



How do you
write?

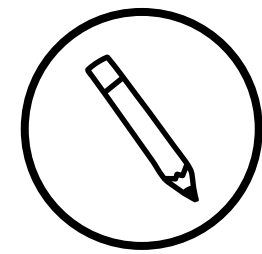
03



To whom do
you write?



LIVENOTE



Why do you write?

It is a process that can help you accomplish a specific objective, specifically to make comparisons or contrasts between two different topics, to argue and debate for a solution to a problem; to create a description of a plan, a project, or a development, to give a summary about a particular topic, and to make a report on an experiment, a capstone or a research project.

The following questions must be answered for you to know the purpose WHY DO YOU WRITE:

What do you want to accomplish?

Why are you sending this message?



Give your answers!

You are writing because you want to accomplish - - - .

You are writing to send this message because - - -

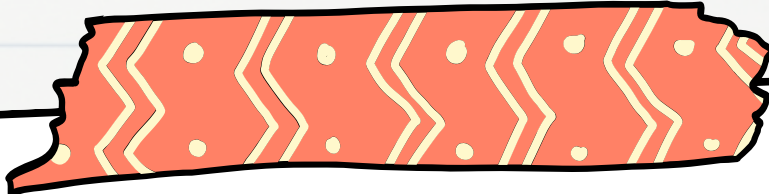


How do you write?

The following are key elements needed to effectively write:

- Sentences and Clauses
- Paragraph



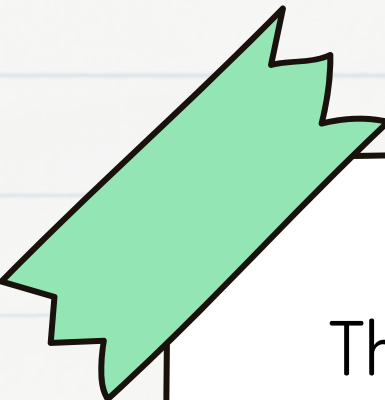


How do you know what a sentence is?

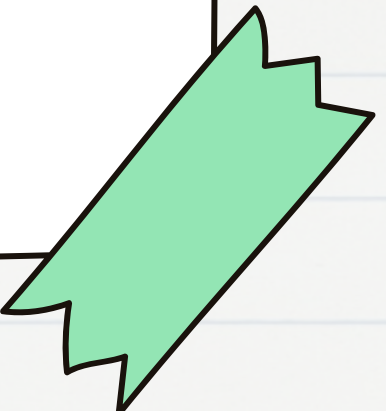
A sentence is a group of words that contains a subject and a verb and expresses a complete thought.



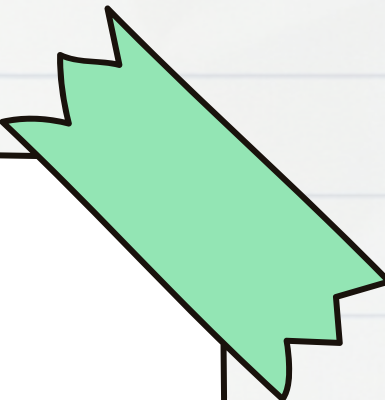
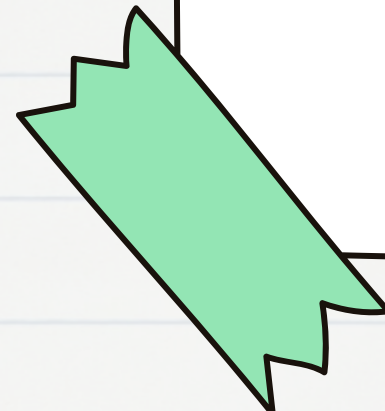
How do you know what a sentence is?



These are **sentences**:

1. He is a student
 2. It is hot today.
 3. He looks tired.
 4. Are you hungry?
 5. Who's there?
 6. Hurry!
 7. The man bought a new car
 8. Does your sister live with you?
 9. Where did you buy that hat?
 10. Don't be late.
- 

These are **not sentences**:

11. Is very athletic.
 12. The baby sleepy.
 13. The man bought.
 14. When I finish my education.
- 
- 

Is very athletic (There is no subject.)

- In some languages, you can leave out a pronoun subject (he, she, it, we, you, and they) when the meaning is clear without it. English requires a subject in every sentence.
- CORRECTED: He is very athletic.

The baby sleepy. (There is no verb.)

- In some languages, you can leave out a verb like is or are when the meaning is clear without it. English requires a verb in every sentence.
- CORRECTED: The baby is sleepy.

The man bought. (This is not a complete thought. What did the man buy?)

- Many verbs in English require an object. (An object is a noun or pronoun that follows a verb.) Some of these verbs are buy, give, have, like, love, need, own, place, put, spend, and want.
- CORRECTED: The man bought a cup of coffee

When I finish my education. (This is not a complete thought. What will happen when I finish my education?)

- A group of words that begins with when, if, or because (and others) is only half of a sentence. You must join it to another subject and verb to make a complete thought.
- CORRECTED: When I finish my education, I will work for my uncle



Command Sentences

If a sentence gives a command or instruction, we understand that the subject is you, but we don't say or write you. The verb in a command sentence is always in the simple (dictionary) form-stop, go, wait, be, eat. To make a command negative, put don't in front of the verb



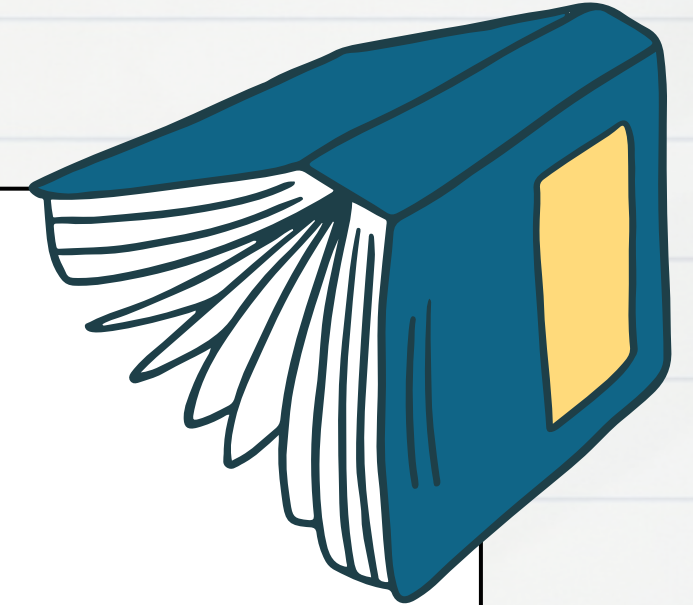
Commands

(You) Be quit!
(You) Wait for me!
(You) Speak Slowly.

Negative commands

(You) Don't eat so much!
(You) Don't forget to call home.
(You) Don't worry.

Subject, Verbs, Object



The subject tells who or what did something. It is a noun or pronoun.

My roommate lost his keys

(Who lost his keys? -my roommate)

The taxi hit the child.

(What hit the child? -the taxi)

Soccer and tennis are my favorite sports.

(What are my favorite sports? -soccer and tennis)



Subject, Verbs, Object

The verb usually tells an action. Sometimes a verb doesn't tell an action. Sometimes, it just links the subject with the rest of the sentence.

Action verbs name an action, such as **hit, live, lose, speak, go, and come.**

The taxi hit the child.

My family lives in a two-bedroom apartment.

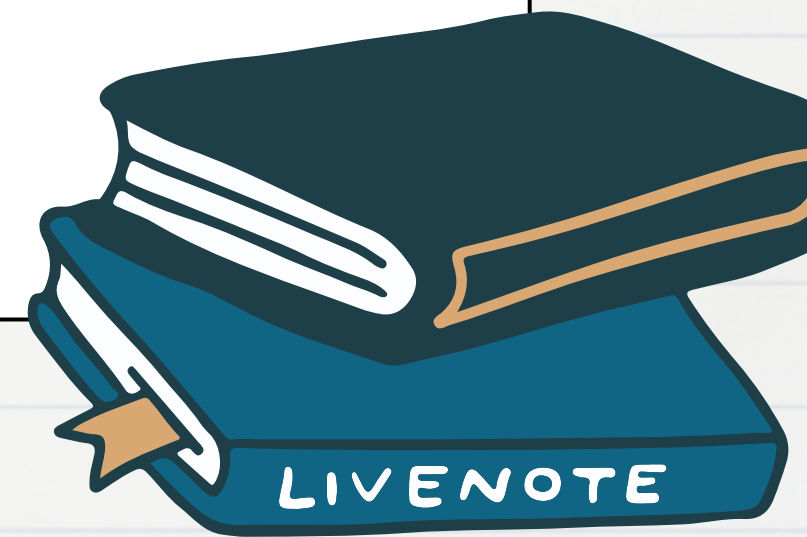
My roommate lost his keys.

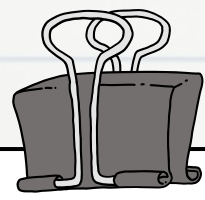
Linking verbs link the subject with the rest of the sentence. Linking verbs do not have objects. The most common linking verbs are be, become, look, feel, seem, smell, sound, and taste.

Soccer and tennis **are** my favorite sports.

I **feel** lucky. today.

The air **smells** fresh and clean.





Subject, Verbs, O**b**j**e**c****t****

The object receives the action of an action verb. It is a noun or a pronoun.

To find an object, make a question by putting what after an action verb (Note: This method for finding objects doesn't work with linking verbs because linking verbs do not have objects.)

The taxi hit **the child**

(Hit what?–the child. The child is an object.)

My roommate lost **his keys**.

(Lost what?–his keys. His keys is an object.)

His girlfriend found **them**.

Found what?–them. Them is an object.)

My family lives in a two-bedroom apartment.

(Lives what?– not possible. This sentence has no object.)

The sun is shining today.

(Is shining what?–not possible. This sentence has no object.)

The fish didn't smell fresh.

(Didn't smell what?–not possible. This sentence has no object.)

Let's Practice!

Identify subjects, verbs, and objects in sentences

- Step 1 Underline the subjects with one line.
- Step 2 Underline the verbs with two lines.
- Step 3 Circle the objects.
- Step 4 Write S, v, or O above each underlined or circled word.

1. My youngest brother is in high school.

(There is no object.)

2. He watches TV and does (homework) at the same time.

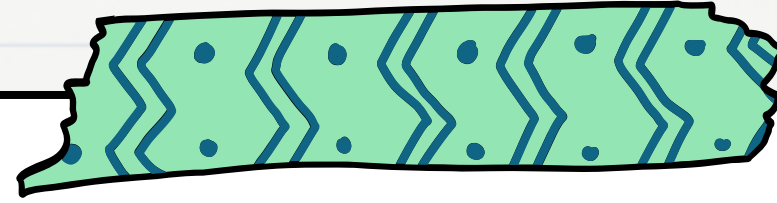
3. He works at a shopping mall.

4. He likes his job but doesn't like his boss.

5. His job is easy and pays well

6. This semester, he is taking extra classes.

7. He will go to college next year.



Take a look at this!

A **simple sentence** has one subject-verb pair. The subject tells who or what did something. The verb tells the action (jump, work, think) or condition (is, was, seem, appear).

- Filmmaker George Lucas has changed the film industry in many ways.
- One new technology was a special computer-assisted camera crane.

Compound Sentence

is two simple sentences connected by comma and a coordinating conjunction.

Simple Sentence	Coordinating Conjunction	Simple Sentence
My family goes camping every summer	and	we usually have fun.
Last year we went camping at Blue Lake	but	we had a terrible time.
Next year we will go to the beach	or	perhaps we will stay at home.
We want to buy a house soon	so	we need to save money.

CLAUSES



01

An **independent clause** has one Subject Verb pair and expresses a complete thought.

Independent clause is just another name for a simple sentence.

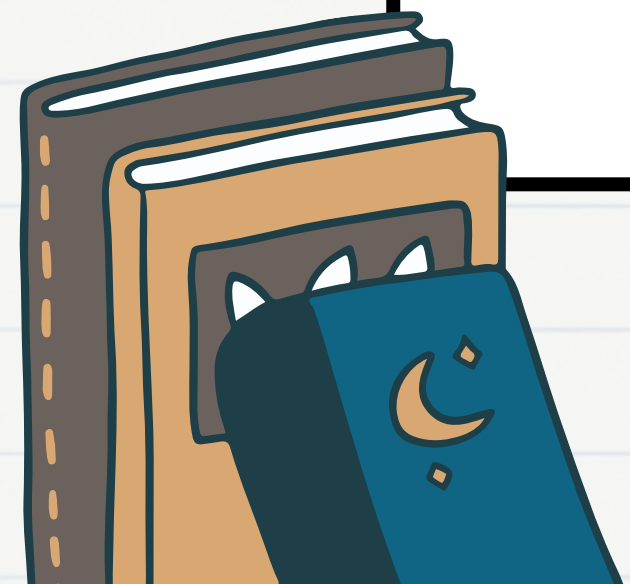
- Paris has excellent art museums
- We finished our homework.

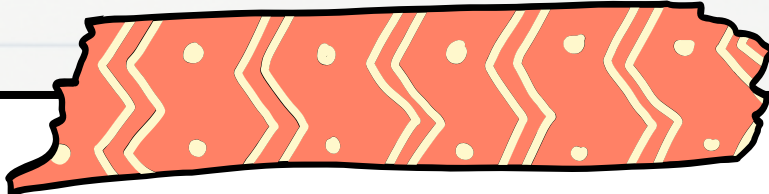
02

A **dependent clause** is an independent clause with a subordinating word, such as because, after, and when, added to the beginning of it.

- ___ **because** Paris has excellent art museums ___
- ___ **after** we finished our homework ___

A dependent clause does not express a complete thought, so it is not a sentence by itself. It is only half of a sentence. It **MUST** be joined to an Independent clause. Together, the two clauses express a complete thought.





Complex Sentence

A complex sentence has one independent clause and one (or more) dependent clauses.

- When the dependent clause begins with an adverb subordinator, the clauses can usually be in any order.

We ran for shelter as soon as it started to rain.

As soon as it started to rain, we ran for shelter.

- If the independent clause is first, don't use a comma.
- If the dependent clause is first, put a comma after it.





Paragraph

A paragraph is a group of related sentences about a single topic. The topic of a paragraph is one, and only one idea. A paragraph has three main parts:

- **Topic sentence**

The first sentence in a paragraph is a sentence that names the topic and tells what the paragraph will explain about the topic. This sentence is called the topic sentence.

- **Supporting sentences**

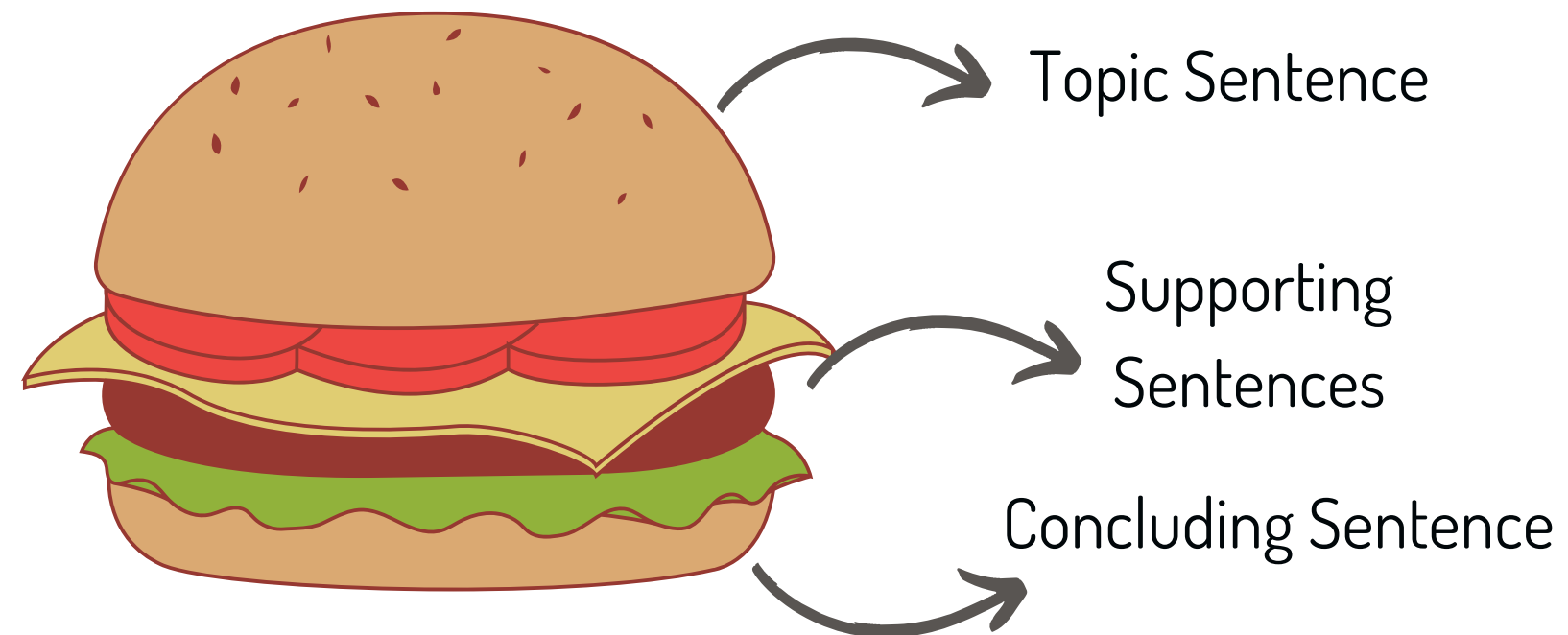
The middle sentences in a paragraph are called the supporting sentences. Supporting sentences gives examples or other details about the topic.

- **Concluding sentence**

The last sentence in a paragraph is called the concluding sentence. A concluding sentence often repeats the topic sentence in different words or summarizes the main points.



A paragraph is like a cheeseburger sandwich: two pieces of bread (the topic and concluding sentence) enclosing the filling (the supporting sentence).



Each paragraph that you write for this class, should have a **TITLE**. A title tells the topic of the paragraph in a few words. It is short and it is not a complete sentence. It may be just one word.

Here are some examples of titles:

- My Classmate
- Friendship
- A Famous Soccer Player.



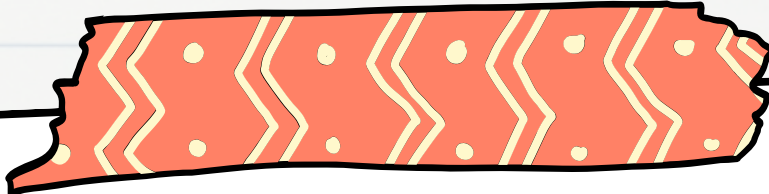
Read the following examples and identify the three parts of a paragraph.

Mr. Robinson

(1) My first grade teacher was an important person in my life. (2) Her name was Mrs. Robinson. (3) In the schools in my country, children usually learn to print before they learn to write. (4) Mrs. Robinson didn't believe in printing. (5) She thought it was waste of time. (6) She taught us to write in cursive a script (like handwriting) from the first day. (7) At first it was hard. (8) She made us practice a lot. (9) I remember filling entire pages just with capital Os. (10) At the end of the year, we felt very grown up because we could write in cursive. (11) Mrs. Robinson was important in my life because she taught me a valuable lesson. (12) I can achieve anything by working hard.

My Best Friend

(1) My best friend, Freddie, has three important qualities. (2)First of all, Freddie is always ready to have fun. (3) Sometimes we play Frisbee in the park. (4) Sometimes, we just sit around in my room, listening to music and talking. (5) Well, I talk. (6) Freddie just listens. (7) Second, he is completely trustworthy. (8) I can tell Freddie my deepest secrets, and he doesn't share them with anyone else. (9)Third, Freddie understands my moods. (10) When I am angry, he tries to make me feel better. (11) When I am sad, he tries to comfort me. (12) When I am happy, he is happy too. (13) To sum up, my best friend is fun to be with, trustworthy, and understanding even if he is just a dog.



To whom do you write?

Communication is the ultimate purpose of writing. The reason why a writer writes is to communicate. Writers need to know the people who will read what they write. The purpose of writing is to effectively communicate the message. Hence, knowing your audience in academic writing is crucial because it directly impacts the effectiveness of what you communicate in writing.



Here are some reasons why knowing your audience in academic writing is important:

- **Communication:** Adjusting your language and level of technicalities helps in ensuring that the message is delivered well to the readers.
- **Engagement:** Understanding your audience's interests, background, and level of comprehension makes them stay interested in your work
- **Relevance:** It allows you to focus on aspects of the topic that are relevant and meaningful to them.
- **Tone and Style:** Tailoring the tone and style of your writing to your audience creates a stronger connection and establishes credibility.
- **Impact and Influence:** It gives you the opportunity to address their needs and concerns and it increases the likelihood that your work will have impact and influence on their perspectives, decisions, and actions.



Pre-writing Activity: Asking Questions and Taking Notes

Whenever you write, you need ideas to write about. Taking notes is one way to get ideas. In this activity, you will ask a classmate some questions and take notes about his or her answers.

You may ask your classmate about:

- Why do you write?
- How do you write?
- To whom do you write?

Here are some other topics you can use and explore for asking questions and taking notes:

- Childhood Memories.
- Dreams and Aspirations.
- Nature and Environment.
- Unanswered Questions.
- Love and Relationships.

Sample answers:

"I write because I want to express myself..."

"I write to tell my friend about my trip..."

"My childhood is a happy one..."

"I write to improve my skills..."



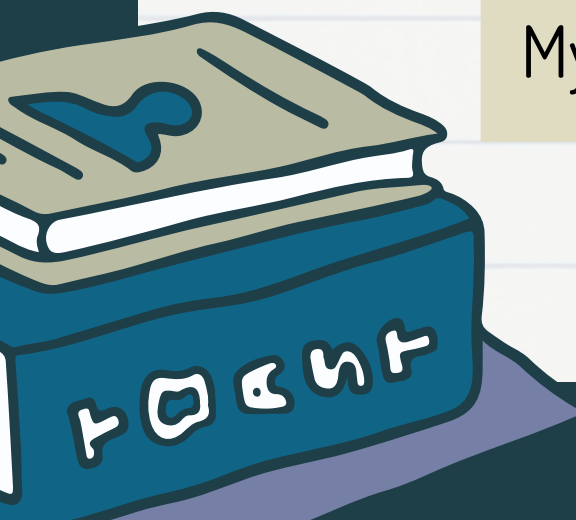
Formative Assessment

- Write a paragraph about the answer of your classmate.
- Give your paragraph a title.
- Begin with a topic sentence and continue with several sentences. Use your notes to make your sentences.
- End your paragraph with a concluding sentence.
- Check your paragraph and read it to the classmate whom you interviewed.
- Submit your piece of writing through the link provided in Google Drive and follow the other instructions of your lecturer.



Paragraph Checklist

My paragraph has an appropriate title.	
My paragraph follows the proper punctuation and mechanics.	
My paragraph fits the assignment, and it is interesting to read.	
My paragraph begins with a topic sentence that has both a topic and a controlling idea.	
My paragraph contains several supporting sentences that explain or prove the topic sentence.	
My paragraph ends with an appropriate concluding sentence.	



Characteristics of Effective Feedback

- Directs attention to the intended learning or learning targets, pointing out strengths and offering specific information to guide improvement.
- Occurs during learning, while there is still time to act on it
- Addresses partial understanding.
- Does not do the thinking for the student.
- Limits corrective information to the amount of advice the student can act on.



Thank You

